VANASTHALI RURAL DEVELOPMENT CENTER, PUNE

ANNUAL REPORT 2023-2024

50th Personality Development Camp - June 2023

Varsha Sahasrabudhhe received Nirmala Purskar from Dr. Vivek Sawant - January 2024

Hobby Class

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FOREWORD :

VRDC family is once again back with its annual report and we are happy to greet all its well wishers, donors, supporters, volunteers and everyone associated with it in some way or the other, to make the organization's work meaningful and true to its purpose.

The schools eagerly welcome back our teachers when the new academic year begins and in fact actively seek their support and help to cope with the various demands on their time and capacities while handling the young eager children, demanding parents , demands of expanding syllabus and of changing times. Parents not very aware of the children's needs and troubled by their own economic or other problems. Therefore the children do need extra support to come out of their shells and try to learn & bloom.

It is only sometimes and on their part very rightly so, the Kendra pramukhs , Gat shikshan adhikaris(various level educational officers) re evaluate the necessity of the presence of outside organisations like ours, the usefulness and consider feedback from all concerned parties. It has been always our practice to start and carryout work with prior information and permission and confirmation with relevant authorities.

During this year all VRDC programs were fully operational and in spirit of rejuvenation. Some of our teachers stopped work due mainly to personal reasons & on the other hand, some rejoined after a necessary break of a year or two or a few years gap, taken due to familial responsibilities or similar reasons. Many a young ones joined our training courses and expected to join in VRDC work. As such the number of women with VRDC for carrying out various programs more or less still remained around 480-520, which is a very encouraging part of the natural churning process.

In such a scenario we eagerly look forward for support from all quarters, in various forms too

Nirmala Karya Gaurav Puraskar : This award was instituted after VRDC's Founder President Nirmala tai's demise and this was the 5th year . The award was conferred on Ms. Varsha Sahasrabuddhe, Pune. Mainly an innovative educationist at heart and linguist by interest & also due to necessity of work (mainly for Tribal languages), her works' focus in the field has been on quality, access and inclusion. She has received recognition at local , national and also at international levels by being conferred various responsibilities of various tasks.

This award was conferred on her by Mr. Vivek Sawant an eminent personality in the field of capacity building, the chief mentor, of Maharashtra Knowledge corporation limited (originally promoted by the department of Higher and technical education)

It was a very well attended event , including members of the Purandare family, invitees, well wishers of VRDC work hailing from many fields , VRDC Supervisors and Trustees and such others.

Both, the receiver of the Award and the chief guest gave

thought provoking and enlightening speeches, very well appreciated by the audience.

Atmasanman Puraskar : This was held immediately after the Nirmal Karya Gaurav Puraskar function was concluded at the same venue. In this continued long time span of VRDC's work , its strength is seen in its ground level, hard working teachers, who many a times have faced difficult situations in their personal life and shown initiative & determination to overcome the odds faced by them and go ahead to contribute to the social cause with VRDC.

One of our trustee Mr. Abhay Shah & family decided to donate a certain prize amount as a token of appreciation for these teachers & thus this award of **Atmasanman-** recognition and honoring of self dignity. In its 1st year 7 teacher- supervisors were honoured with this award- 1.Sharmila Salunkhe, 2. Sunanda Dalvi, 3. Kausalya Kurhe, 4.Swati Vibhute, 5.Chaya Petare, 6.Archana Sonawane, 7.Surekha Kumbhar .

It was a very special moment in their life & they voiced this overwhelming feeling. Family members of the awardees attended the function and showed & expressed great appreciation towards VRDC.

Shibir : Residential Camp : VRDC has been organising refresher residential camps since almost from the beginning with an objective of providing refresher trainings, opportunity to mix & mingle with teachers, trainees from different centres of VRDC. This gave a chance to exchange ideas & information, sharing of feelings & to know other ways of living may be the language, the regular food habits etc. Similarly an added feature of these was cultural, entertainment programs at the end of the day. This is a very favourite activity as there is full scope for self expression as many a time they don't enjoy back home a simple thing like

taking a few dance steps & similar things of explorings one's talents.

This year VRDC held its **50th shibir** at Pune, **bet. 6th to 9th June,** @ Vidyarthi sahayyak Samiti's Dr. Atchutrao Apte ladies Hostel**. 218 women participated**.

Various discussion sessions, group study sessions were arranged to touch on many topics like drawing & coloring, fine arts including dramatics, science experiments, Important role of Brain development & role of child psychology in children's education, progress & achievements in later years, the concept of home schooling, education of the blind & such.

Mr. B.N.Mishra, Mr. Makarand Tillu, Ms. Madhuri Purandare, Ms. Sunruta Sahasrabuddhe, Malati Tai Kelkar, Manik Tai Kotwal guided/ addressed the various sessions. Mr. Swagat Thorat who has done a lot of work for the blind to make their learning process smoother, to make their life easier performed a play addressing these different issues in their life & to make the sighted look at them with an evolved vision.

The inauguration was at the hands of Dr. Kamaladevi Auti, Assistant director, SCERT. She addressed the gathering with her insight on the new national Educational policy and how to fruitfully adopt the changes accordingly.

This being the 50th special shibir the concluding session was in the presence of the Trustees of VRDC with The President Mrs. Nirmal Tai Pendharkar present on the occassion, she addressed the gathering which was filled with special emotions and nostalgia. The changes happening around in the society, in the educational field, the challenges these pose for us, the VRDC family, the responsibility it imposes on all, the financial challenges NGO's like us can face were the points of discussion and it brought forth the solidarity feelings of all those present,

including the well- wishers & supporters of VRDC.

About the VRDC organization-objectives and activities :

Vanasthali Rural Development Centre, established at the end of 1981 completed 42 years of its work with rural children and rural semi- literate women in this year. The organization was established to fill up the gap between the beginning of compulsory primary education at the age of six years (1st std.) and no availability of learning facilities up to that age in rural areas, with the effect of losing out on important years of learning. Sustaining into the formal educational system is a practice and has to be slowly introduced by taking into consideration the child psychology at that age and it takes time for it to be well rooted. Local and family background too normally affects these very important and tender years in the childhood.

Considering these important factors in child learning and development which have considerable bearing on the future years, the founder members stood strongly behind the ideas of the founder president Ms. Nirmala Purandare .They firmly believed that the foundation of a good learned, enlightened personality is laid at an early age so, the first few years are very crucial years of mental development for any child and need to be meaningfully addressed to. As such, starting of pre-primary educational program was considered a necessity and the most basic program. Though the ground reality over the years has changed a lot, one still dare not say that, it has lost its importance or necessity.

It was observed at the time of floating the organisation,that a huge potential workforce in the form of the home bound, semi literate rural women was available to act as facilitators of building child education and development foundation. The

founders of VRDC tapped into this source, by training these locally available women to work as teachers of these local rural children lacking in pre-primary, foundation level educational opportunities. It aimed towards additional continuous inputs to build up on the basic training so as to keep all the programs, activities fresh and interesting and relevant over a period of time.

This is a period of big churning, for working towards better Society. Though many changes are taking place, a lot many areas need attention with follow up. The educational system, a field of VRDC concern, still suffers from many adversities resulting in poor quality, especially in rural areas.

Through all these years VRDC has continued to give training to the eager, aspiring rural women, who look forward to a meaningful change in their home bound life. Refresher trainings, new inputs, review of work and analysis to improve work, incorporation of new activities and programs when required, trying to address new found educational needs and to keep up with changes, continuously trying to adapt and evolve, to enhance, not only for the children's learning opportunities but also to open up supportive avenues to the aspiring young women, has been the focus of our effort over all these years.

VRDC's regular work is spread into nine districts of Maharashtra. Additionally some trainings or residential camps, library work, were conducted earlier in Alibaug , Raigad district and at Ratnagiri, in Konkan region of Maharashtra.

Pune, Ahmed Nagar, Satara, Nashik, Solapur, Sangali, Latur, Sindhudurg, Kolhapur are the 9 districts and has about 480 trained women working as VRDC's honorary teachers, carrying out various educational activities for about 30000 children every year and hold Teacher Training courses where there is a demand. As such, in all these 42 years VRDC has catered to a big number

of children and women, who have taken the support of the opportunities created by VRDC and moved on in their life for better.

TRAINING COURSE FOR WOMEN :

Backbone of VRDC programs, a well thought out and disciplined, 6 months duration course to train rural women, has been developed and used over the years with needed additions and inputs . It trains the women in various areas of child education, inclusive of different models and methodologies for early child education, child health and nutrition, child psychology, child, women and social welfare, school management and such. Practical training in crafts, games, language skills, songs and stories, use of project method, are given importance that is due in children's education. The trainees visit a few other child welfare organizations for increased exposure and awareness.

The course offers an opportunity for rural women to come out of their home bound life and at the same time remain closely associated with their children's upbringing. The villagers in turn understand the importance of child education, personality development of local women and the benefits it brings to the quality of their life.

Through the years, training has been imparted to around **18000** women spread over **9** districts of Maharashtra. Along with being part of VRDC's own resource personnel, many of the trained women have been absorbed eagerly by ICDS program- Anganwadi, government & private Balwadis (pre-primary or nursery schools). Private organizations working with young children have also sought their trained services; additionally they have been employed in crèche facilities or any

work involving engagement with the children of the said age group.

Through the experience of our trained teachers, VRDC compiled a special guide-cum-textbook, 1st edited by VRDC founder president, (late) Ms.Nirmala Purandare. It covers various subject areas of our teachers' training, is titled as 'Balwaditai Prashikshan –an educational journey towards an evolved personality'. It was 1st published in 1999 and received the Maharashtra state sponsored 'Yashvantrao Chavhan' award.

VRDC came out with its revised version, in its 9th edition in the year 2019. The lead role in this revision work was that of our senior trustee Manik kotwal, an Educationist & a writer, assisted by Sunanda Navale, senior Teacher Trainer in the organization and helped by another trustee, Sushama Sathaye. This edition was a necessity of time and of changes happening in our society and so, the need to address new topics like learning disabilities, new laws for child welfare and similar other inclusions were important.

Our song collection book too was revised with a lot of additions. This year saw a renewed interest in the training course program and there was a good response in various centres of VRDC.

Superviser Meeting at Pune

It is reflected in the given table-

Training Courses : 2023-2024

Sr.No.	District	No.of Courses	Trainees
1.	Pune	8	135
2.	Satara	3	51
3.	Nashik	1	15
4.	Sangli	1	17
5.	Kolhapur	1	08
6.	Solapur	1	17
Total		**15**	**243**

BALWADI :

VRDC activities started with the purpose of providing learning opportunity to the rural children in the age group of 3 to 6 years. So, the trained women were encouraged and guided to start preschools. Eager and energetic, the children in the age group of 3-6 years are ready to absorb many new experiences and information and this is precisely what is achieved by our Balwadi program.

Disciplined behavior and habits, foundation for literacy i.e. reading and writing, confidence in behavior and speech, improved memory and response, recitation, better motor development with the help of lot of games and crafts and many other free learning activities improves their performance in comparison to children who lack this training in early years. Primary school teachers are happy to accommodate VRDC balwadi children in their classes as the required basic educational foundation is well laid.

In the changing socio-eco-political scenario we find that the number of our Balwadis is getting affected. At present we

have 62 balwadis which accommodate and try to reach out to children from socially deprived and economically backward sections of the local population. Many a time the children attending our balwadis belong to daily wage earners, special communities like vaidu, gosavi, Potraj and others, contract/ migratory labour.

Balwadi No's. :

Sr.No.	District	No of Balwadis	No of Teachers	No of Children
1.	Pune	14	15	342
2.	Nasik	1	1	45
3.	Solapaur	5	5	126
4.	Nagar	1	1	22
5.	Sangali	3	3	55
6.	Latur	28	28	1130
	Total	**52**	**53**	**1720**

LEARNING ENHANCEMENT ACTIVITY PROGRAM (LEAP)/ HOBBYCLASSES :

An offshoot of our work with children and its popularity, hobby classes were launched to give avenues for talent exploration and creativity, to the school going children in the age group of 6 to 12 years. Originally seen only as an extra-curricular activity, it evolved to accommodate special requirements of strengthening reading and writing skills of children who were lagging behind in spite of moving to higher classes in schools. With our ongoing work, our teachers reported back about the problems related to learning process faced by children attending Zilha parishad/ Nagar Parishad schools. A

number of activities are conducted to answer this problem and other educational difficulties faced by the children, by giving them varied and enriched educational experiences. Thus the program evolved from being just a hobby class activity to a learning enhancement activity program, resulting in better overall performance and capabilities and improved confidence of the children. A concentrated special training is given to our trained teachers to conduct these variety of activities .This program is found to be a great support to not only the school going children but it is also appreciated by school authorities for its effects.

Our six month duration training course includes this special training and is also made available separately and has a properly developed curriculum. Revision and refresher courses are conducted from time to time.

Aims of the LEAP – (age group 6 to 12) **:**

1. Encouragement to pursue natural hobbies of the children.
2. Give way for personal choices and creativity and enthusiasm at their own pace.
3. Waste utilization for craft,which creates awareness and sensitivity towards wastage, saving and utilisation of available resources, and environment.
4. Promote observation and collection habits, inculcate curiosity about surroundings.
5. Expression of unexplored talents in different art forms.
6. Promote increased participation in extra-curricular activities like indoor- outdoor games, paper craft – drawing and painting, storytelling, theatre and poetry.
7. Inculcating and creating awareness of values of life.
8. All these leading to Increased interest in formal studies.

9. Improvement in performance of educationally backward children by applying these different learning methods.

To achieve these goals, activities are thoughtfully planned and carried out. With school's permission, the work experience classes scheduled in the school timetable are utilized for these purposes. Library activity is also made a part of this program.

Activity Camps for Children : Every year 2 camps, one in summer and one during Diwali vacations, are held for the duration of 3-5 days each, for children of surrounding villages of the center or the regular VRDC beneficiary children. Parents, villagers, teachers and other locals are invited to visit and know about these camps. Children and our LEAP teachers get encouragement from this participation of the locals. This year **summer camps** were not held as actively as always, because the schools had started functioning just a couple of months earlier, after the long gap of 2 years of the Pandemic. Even so, they were held in **4** of VRDC **regional centres**, at **137 places** and **1199 children** actively participated. **Winter camps** showed almost full normalcy and were held in **all 9 districts**, at **156 places** and **17045 children** took advantage of the various activities arrange . Local community supports this activity by providing various craft materials and snacks for the children.

Games, craftwork, songs, stories, story books, reading, drawing, flower decoration, puzzles, clay work, handwriting or other competitions, mask making, preparing of very simple snacks, cleanliness and hygiene, making of bird nests, small science experiments, flower rangoli , making of greeting cards, collage art work, small skits and conversation skill activity, recitation of Sanskrit shlokas, poems, folk forms like Powada and many more activities were held. Children enjoyed the varied experiences. Current status of this program is visible at a glance

in the given tables ahead:

1. Regular, 2. At Observation homes and Ashram schools LEAP/Hobby Class Activity at Municipal and Zilha Parishad Schools

Sr. No.	District	Schools	No of hobby classes	No. of Teachers	No. of Children
1	Pune	63	168	168	7047
2	Satara	34	92	92	3960
3	Kolhapur	09	20	20	2140
4	Sindhudurg	07	11	11	484
5	Sangali	08	27	27	827
6	Latur	11	28	28	1164
7	A.Nagar	23	37	37	1156
8	Nashik	06	41	41	1985
9	Solapur	04	04	08	160
	Total	**165**	**428**	**428**	**18923**

LEAP Work in Observation(Remand)Homes and Ashram schools

Sr. No.	District	No. of Remand Homes and Ashram schools	No of Teachers	No. of Children
1.	Pune	3	4	127
2.	A.Nagar	5	5	213
3.	Satara	1	1	120
4.	Sangali	1	1	147
5.	Kolhapur	2	2	78
	Total	**12**	**13**	**685**

JEJURI PRIMARY SCHOOL :

VRDC started a primary school at Jejuri in 1996, encouraged and prompted by local parents' demand, in spite of there being many Marathi Medium and English Medium private schools available as a choice for the parents. The school has continued to get good support and on an average had about 200 children attending the school every year. The numbers were affected somewhat due to the after effects of the pandemic, but started improving too.

Under the guidance of VRDC supervisor, Sunanda Aaglave and the leadership of very enthusiastic Principal, Mrs Ujwala Jejurikar, the school has gained a good reputation. The school's students are performing well in many local competitions held from time to time. The school students participated in cleanliness drive and tree plantation drive and performed skits which were received well. In local cultural festivals the school children have earned themselves top honors in successive years. It has adopted semi- English pattern from 2009 and also has basic computer education made available for the school children. Training in karate and abacus math system is provided. Children are also encouraged to appear for state scholarship, 'Pradnya Shodh (Talent Search), and other competitive examinations like Manthan. All children are encouraged to participate in all the curricular and extra-curricular activities without making any discrimination and they are encouraged to enjoy the learning process.

A well- stocked library is being enjoyed by the school students, teachers and parents. Various festivals are celebrated, along with understanding the meaning behind each special tradition.

The school was paid a few evaluation visits by the

KendraPramukh and the work was found to be satisfactory. Mr. Konde, construction engineer and a native of Jejuri, paid a couple of visits to check on the structure for possible improvements and 2 officials of Hi-Tech consultancy paid a visit for similar evaluation. Also, Mr. Avinash who takes interest in school design as a social cause, other than his main business, paid evaluation visits. Ms. Manasi from Bajaj (CSR) paid a visit to the school and interacted with the teachers & students of the school. Regular trustee visits were made to the school.

Teachers and school children enjoyed yearly outdoor trips and 'Van Bhojan', a lunch together in natural surroundings.

Regular Meetings with the parents and of Parent-Teacher association are held to build up rapport and keep the children's interests central in the functioning of the school.

Nos. of Jejuri Primary School

Std	Boys	Girls	Total
1st	28	11	**39**
2nd	28	26	**54**
3rd	18	23	**41**
4th	26	23	**49**
Total	**100**	**83**	**183**

Though the school has no grant of assistance from the state government, it doesn't suffer in its work. Development Officer, center in-charge, group education officials visit the school, they co-operate and give guidance too, as and when required. Many parents gift items of necessity or snacks at the time of the annual function or last day of the academic year. Health check-up of the children is done at Jejuri primary health centre.

LIBRARY ACTIVITY :

Regular Library: VRDC library activity has grown to a stage where it can be easily called a library movement and is very well supported by **'Panpoee Vachanalayas'** ,a library program, which was initiated by then our trustee and now VRDC President, Nirmal Pendharkar and her family and is **very well supported by HOH, USA.** All the VRDC centers benefit by receiving a variety of books for children as well as some for adults in villages i.e. the teachers, parents, etc. More than 45,000 books in numbers, of various subjects & titles have been distributed so far. The VRDC hobby class teachers are given inputs about their utilization. Books are thoroughly enjoyed by the children as well as some adults too.

In addition to the regular library activity there are **5 Panpoee libraries** at Talegaon Dhamdhere (2Nos.), Siddarth Hostel and Maratha Hostel at Parner, benefiting 445 children. 7 VRDC teachers are engaged for these.

Mobile Library Program :

The mobile van library activity has been started and running to benefit the school children of villages where regular library or LEAP/ hobby class activity cannot be run due to various reasons, mainly lack of regular public transport for our teachers. So, a van is used to try to achieve similar goals of promoting – art, craft, and reading- writing skills and to carry out other regular LEAP activities.

2-3 teachers accompanying the van carry all the necessary material including books. Various schools have enthusiastically joined the project and large number of children have benefitted. About 20 schools in and around one center are catered to by this mode, which reach & benefit about 2500-3000 children.

Baramati region Mobile Van, where the project first started in 2008, is supported by **Partage, France**; this activity is still getting good response from the local area schools. Mobile van based activity is also carried out at **Lasalgaon**, Dist. Nashik and is supported by **'Home of Hope,' USA**

Shirval Dist. Satara : supported by **N.G.Paranjape Pratishthan**. There was a renewed interest shown this year in this project by all involved quarters- the teachers to carry out the activity work, the schools & the services of the van driver/ vendor, & most importantly the Donor supporter.

There is a demand for more such work and we may consider it if, any funding support comes specifically for the activity.

Pustak Mazhya Daari (Home Library) :

'Book at My Door-Step' a concept of home library, is run **by 27 teachers**, in Somatane, Chikhali, Andarmaval, Kamshet, Pavanangar, Saswad, Baramati urali-kanchan, Talegaav-dabhade, Bhor, Shreerampur, Sangmaner, Lalsalgaav, Kirloskarvadi, Loanand, Devgad.

Total **427 children** take benefit of this program.

To understand the children's progress, we give importance to holding various competitions like open book reading, recitation, skit presentation, comprehension. The emphasis on this activity is not only about making books available, but to make the program interactive and participatory, so as to increase overall exposure of the children to various subjects that affect our lives in addition to improve their reading skills. It is also considered important to encourage them to think and express in their own words and develop various skills of language usage. Vanasthali teachers try their best to encourage reading habit of the children. For the Past 2 years there has also been emphasis

on online training for these teachers.

SCIENCE PROMOTION THROUGH EXPERIMENTS :

It was observed that there are many scientific experiments mentioned in school science text books, but the children hardly get an opportunity to carry these out and observe and understand the concepts for themselves. This creates many hurdles in their understanding of the natural phenomena. To address this problem a special science experiments-based activity was started. At the start itself, special trainings and necessary inputs were given to Vanasthali teachers with the help of outside resource personnel and visits to IUCCA, Pune. Experiment Material Kits are given to the teachers and through them it is available for use to the children to conduct various experiments, observe, note down the points and their findings. In this year about **17 teachers** are running this program in about **9 schools** in **Shirgaon ,Vadgaon, Kamshet, Dapodi, and Saswad area, benefiting 541 school children from standard 4th to 7th**. Online trainings by Mrs. Kotwal throughout the year was an integral part of the continuous preparation for promotion of the scientific outlook.

Science Experiment Exhibitions were held at different schools to celebrate the Science Day and to impress the young minds about the importance of Science in our daily life.

Special science exhibition too was arranged at our Somatane center for which 3 guests from Skill development foundation along with3 VRDC senior trustees and volunteers of the Bitwise Foundation, which supports the science program were present and interacted with the participants. It show cased the efforts of the children and teachers, and the year round activity for achieving the special purpose.

95 Children and 11 Teachers, from 6 areas in Maval

Taluka visited Science Center at Chinchwad and also carried out some science experiments there.

'Quest' was established by **Ms.Malati Kelkar** and her family for promotion of Science through experiment based learning. She has also helped in the past few years to train and give special exposure to VRDC teachers to run the science experiment program. This year she donated **40 'Vidnyan Petya', (special trunks) ready with material for experiments**, of which 21 were immediately distributed to the program teachers.

Other Initiatives :

Learning from Nature: a visit to Plantation Site Near kamshet was arranged. The site has been developed by individual effort & will of Mr.Vijay Kotwal, which have been Supported by his wife Manik Kotwal and some Local help.

This was followed by a **Visit to Parle biscuit factory at talegaon and Samadhi Mandir at dehu : 60 Children, 6 school teachers and** VRDC volunteers were part of it.

VRDC has kept up with the online skill development trainings for our teachers throughout this year too. The guidance is provided by Manik Kotwal. The teachers are given specially selected material for preparation and for later testing and presentation to understand their own improved competency as well as that of the beneficiary children.

Other Special activities: @ Sangamner there is more stress on book reading guided by the centre supervisor Pushpa Nirhali.

Also **34 girl students** from 'Ramayashodhara' & Kalaskar ashram shala benefit by **stitching Classes** arranged by VRDC regularly. They were taken to nearby places on excursions. Additionally they were taught other handicrafts, various games which they enjoy immensely.

About **130** student inmates from Ramayashodhara & Jai Shankar hostel benefit by the **Karate classes** arranged by VRDC.

: @ Kolhapur: Reading activity sessions are conducted regularly for 40 resident students the Blind school.

: @ our Mahabaleshwar Centre- 85 government Primary School teachers from Panchgani, Metgutad, Machtur **were given special Crafts Training** by VRDC supervisor there Sarita Gudulakar and our other center teachers.

: @ Baramati center many new initiatives are tried and there is special dialogue with the parents. **A special guest lecture** was arranged for the parents about the **child behaviour & their psychology.**

: @ Bitwise office, Pune- VRDC children guided by our teachers presented a short play on '**Saving the Enviornment'** for the employees of the company.

: @ '**Jallosh Shikshanacha'** Pimpri Chinchwad corporation

: @ Bhor : Local women were given training in making cloth bags , some new healthy receipes, reading sessions were conducted.

From Pune office : Bharati Bhide & Sushama Sathaye, the 2 trustees visited number of VRDC work centres throughout the year to maintain direct communication with the teachers, to meet the trainees wherever new teacher training courses were being undertaken or to address any special requirement from the centre.

Sangola, Jejuri, Shrirampur, Lasalgaon-Vinchur, Wai, Shirwal, Lonand, Sinner, Parner, Baramati, Phaltan, Sangamner, Udgir, Talegaon Dhamdhere, Saswad, Uralikanchan, Kolhapur, Kirloskarwadi, Akurdi, Dighi, Somatane, Wadgaon were paid a visit and also the Jallosh shikshanacha was also attended to understand what initiatives are at work in the educational scenario.

GruhaUdyogini : It is necessary to note that VRDC always supported its teachers, in their effort to do small business to support their income. They had borrowed for various purposes like a bangle shop, for keeping & tending goats or hens etc. Yet it was on ad hoc basis and as & when the teacher asked for it. Now an initiative of Gruhaudyogini has started as an ongoing special VRDC program, prompted and financially supported by N.G. Paranjape Pratishthan. under It some teacher beneficiaries have done satisfactorily good for themselves and there are 2-3, a very minor no. of cases, who have faced difficulty in their household business venture. Since the start of this as a program, in year 2021, around **54** VRDC teachers have taken financial support for starting a household business initiative so far. In this year **9** more VRDC teachers sought and received fianacial support for start of their own business. The teachers who earlier availed of this facility are satisfied about their participation in this program.

'Aarogya Sarita ': A healthy body is important to lead a healthy life, is understood by everyone, but the real life experience is that the women in our society, especially from lower economic strata are negligent about taking care of their health and social circumstances too are not very supportive of them. Though VRDC always tried to address this issue with its women teachers/ trainees, in terms of awareness and some small financial help if & when asked for, during the Covid 19 affected period, it bacame an even more important point of consideration and we decided to form a kind of **self-support initiative**. We appealed to all the VRDC fraternity and some donors came forward and whole of VRDC teachers group and the committee members and the office staff too made their contribution towards it. It's an ongoing initiative. Since then every following year

some of VRDC teachers have received this health required financial support for themselves or their very close family members, so far totally **32** teachers have been supported through this initiative.

ANNUAL OUTINGS :

VRDC has encouraged annual outings for Vanasthali teachers, who participate with great enthusiasm. It gives an opportunity to these women to organize short trips out of their villages and to get to know other regions, cultures and cuisine. Through this activity they learn group discipline, organizing skills, planning and leadership, to take shared responsibility.

This is their chance to go out with friends rather than only the family. To mention a few - This year Jejuri school staff visited Hadashi Dam area near Pune and took the school children to Prathamesh garden near Jejuri.

Teachers from Talegaon Dabhade, Kamshet & vadgaon visited Morachi chincholi, an agro tourism venture.

Sinner group visited Gondeshwar for medicinal plantation site.

The Udgir teachers group visited Basaveshwar, a place for devotees & spiritually inclined.

Lonand teacher group visited Kamshet & surrounding dam & other natural settings nearby.

Baramati Teachers and trainees visited 'Darekar wada', a heritage place surrounded by nature wealth.

7 of our senior supervisors ventured out further to the north and enjoyed a cherished trip to Kashmir.

MAGAZINE–'VANASTHALI' :

A bi-monthly publication has been an important part of the VRDC activities through the years. This was started to encourage

the trainees, teachers and supervisors, locals, etc. to pen down their thoughts and observations, to learn to express through various forms of writing and to communicate as well as to channelize exchange of necessary information about socio-political and economical happenings around them.

Since the end of 1999 VRDC regional centres' were encouraged to come out with the publication and learn all the various aspects involved in the process. Till now **45** regular Vanasthali magazines and additional **6** from different centres, devoted to teenagers have been published at VRDC regional centres. Our teachers have developed a good network of well wishers and are many a time able to get advertisements for the publication and support the expenses incurred.

Due to changing economic conditions, VRDC has had to rethink its policy about the publication and this year only **2** 'Vanasthali' issues were published.

SUPERVISORY WORK AND REGIONAL CENTERS : Supervision of these many fold activities is an important aspect to maintain reasonable Quality and standards -of work. It is also necessary to have people locally available, for co-ordination of all the teachers working in various areas, trouble shooting and similar such needs. Local contact building is also an important part of the local responsibility .To carry all this out there is a well knit network of supervisors and assistant supervisors in each area of VRDC work. They maintain dialogue & communication with the Pune office, consult whenever and for whatever is their requirement mainly with the secretary- Bharati Bhide or the concerned trustee acting as the specific program in charge/co ordinator.

The supervisors themselves have undergone the six months duration teachers' training course, have worked as trainers,

balwadi or LEAP/hobby class teachers and additionally have shown leadership qualities and loyalty to VRDC goals and objectives (i.e. overall personality development of the rural children and semiliterate women.) They show integrity and responsibility towards this mission of VRDC. The teachers have a direct contact with the supervisors about their respective work and for at hand guidance, as and when required.

VRDC centers : Vanasthali has developed area specific centers at various places like Baramati, Talegaon, Somatane, Jejuri, Saswad, Urali Kanchan, Shirwal, Shrirampur, Sangamner, Parner, Sinner, Lasalgaon-Vinchur, Sangola-Mahud, Udgir, Kolhapur, Kirloskarwadi, Devgad, Panchgani-Mahabaleshwar, Lonand.

The centers are of help to the local staff to come together for meetings, planning of activities, make educational aids, sharing of work related information and experiences, training, and any other similar needs.

Identity creation due to VRDC work : This whole network of teachers (Balwadi and LEAP/ hobby classes and other activities) assistant supervisors, supervisors and the main office at Pune thus helps to develop a feeling of oneness and an identity to stand out in their local areas as VRDC workers. They get an elevated status in their immediate society. They are also active in self help groups, and many a time are invited by other organizations for imparting training or on special occasions like 'Women's day', 'Children's day', as facilitators for educational workshops and other such activities.

Supervisory meetings at regular intervals are held at Pune office. This year such meetings were held at Pune. These are review meetings used also for exchange of ideas and small trainings.

All 3 meetings were utilized to give guidance about new initiatives, problems related to ongoing programs and find solutions for their successful implementation.

The Total strength of supervisors and Asst. Supervisors :

No.	District	Supr.	Asst.Supr.	Helpers
1.	Pune	7	11	5
2.	Nashik	2	3	1
3.	Solapur	1	-	-
4.	Satara	3	4	-
5.	Nagar	3	3	1
6.	Sangali	1	-	1
7.	Latur	1	1	-
8.	Kolhapur	1	1	-
9.	Sindhudurg	1	-	-
	Total-	20	23	8

FINANCIAL AID : VRDC tries to help in a small way by giving financial support, to alleviate any immediate troubles faced by the teachers & their families. We feel that the teachers need not be troubled or worried wherever help is possible to arrange, especially in matters of health & education. This year support was provided for the following purposes:-

Educational purpose- to 8 Teachers, Mobile phones – 95 Teachers, 1 laptop to Jejuri School and 1 desktop for Parner student

Medical Aid – for 4 Teachers, Personal reason -1

SPECIAL GUESTS :

1. Office bearers of Bitwise Foundation, Pune, India
2. Nilima Sabarval from HOH USA

3. Artitect Avinash – Bangalor, Pune
4. Rotary club Nigdi, Pune- office bearers
5. Ms.Mansi from Bajaj Fin.Pune
6. Ms. Ann Marie from Entre'Inde- France

THANKS : To run a program spread out in 9 districts, 23 talukas and 150 villages, working at grass roots level, we receive local support in various ways from women's groups, youth groups, Grampanchayats, civil corporations, educational officers, school teachers and principals, parents, and villagers. VRDC is thankful for the same and looks forward to continuation of this and additionally local financial support too.

Association of Friends of France, Vidhyarthi Sahayyak Samitee, Janakidevi Bajaj Kendra, are some of our local activity supporters. Additionally there is a big financial support from Bajaj Finance Ltd., Bitwise Foundation, Yardi Software India Pvt. Ltd., & from outside India there are Home of Hope, People for Progress in India (USA), Panah –Schweiz,(Switzerland), Partage Sans Frontieres, Entr'inde (France) This gives our work great strength. Some European and American donors have been with us for many years. There are many individual donors too & they have been supporting VRDC with whatever possible.

Though some donors have withdrawn support now, we would like to remain in gratitude of all of them.

Special thanks to accounts services provided by Mrs. Neha Kulkarni & Mr. Deo in this year and we are very grateful to both of them for carrying out the important work.

Sharmila Salunkhe, Manali Nadkarni are engaged in various necessary tasks at the office. VRDC driver Praveen Pendhare is our person to rely on for all our visits to various centres. All of them carry out their roles well.

Special Mention – Prathamesh, a student of commerce

stream, provided help in the office for computer based work.

Kailas Deshmukh & Chaya, office building watchman & wife, help in carrying out small jobs and are caretakers of the premises.

VRDC Trustees express their gratitude on behalf of all the beneficiaries. We are thankful to all.

Donation in kind : Books and Magazines, cloths, sweaters , Games and toys, variety of stationery, Toy stand, small children chairs, Notice boards, Blue Tooth sound, saplings & pots, wall/ alarm clock, doll house were part of donation received from Vrushali Deuskar, Neeraja Sathaye, Dr.Neeta Gadkari, Ms.Neeta Kankareja, Jyoti Tai Chavhan, Shobha Yeole, Vandana Gurav, Aparna Sable, Anjali Bethehekar, Mr. Sukhdeo Ilhe, Vinita Mahajani, Pradnya Bhosale, Gauri Bapat,Ambekar,Shri. Pagdal,Dattatray Arote, Abhishek Pandit,Balkrushna Mahajan,Jejuri parents group, Baramati Teacher Training course trainees.

List of Foreign Donors

Sr. No.	Name	Amount Rs.	Country
1.	Panah-Schweiz	1,370,580.65	Switzerland
2.	Maharstra Foundation	8,10,476.00	USA
3.	Partage Sans Frontieres	6,30,633.95	France
4.	People for progress in India	5,39,477.75	USA
5.	Home of hope	4,12,650.00	USA
6.	Entr'inde	1,05,948.00	France
	TOTAL	**38,69,760.35**	

List of Indian Donors

1.	Bajaj finance Ltd, Pune-	21,30,153
2.	Yardi Software India Pvt. Ltd, Pune-	5,87,414
3.	Bitwise Foundation, Pune-	4,64,780
4.	Elcom International Pvt. Ltd, Kolhapur-	2,50,000
5.	N.G. Paranjpe Pratisthan- Pune	2,50,000
6.	Sarita Jogalekar-Pune	1,02,000
7.	Shri. Prataprao Pawar, Pune	1,00,000
8.	Nirmal Pendharkar- Pune	1,00,000
9.	Marathwada Mitra Mandal-	75,000
10.	Sushama Sathaye, Pune	51,000
11.	Dr. Nita Gadakari, Pune	50,000
12.	Abhay Shah-Baramati	35,000
13.	Ujjwala Jogalekar, Pune	25,000
14.	Bharati Bhide, Pune-	25,000
15.	Raghunath Jathar, Pune	25,000
16.	Abhay G.Bhanage, Ambegaon Pune	15,000
17.	Shri.Bhausaheb Jadhav, Pune	11,000
18.	Seema Fadnis, Pune	11,000
19.	Sunanda Balgude-Sangamner	10,000
20.	Travelouge Tours & Travels Pvt.Ltd, Pune	10,000
21.	Neeraja Sathaye- Pune	10,000
22.	Sangita Wadekar-Sangamner	10,000

23.	Manik Kotaval-	10,000
24.	Sharmila Salunke, Pune-	5,000
25.	Manisha Kulkarni, Pune-	5,000
26.	Manohar Kulkarni-	5,000
27.	Shubhashchandra Khopkar, Pune	5,000
28.	Pratibha Paranjpe, Pune	5,000
29.	Ravindra Namjoshi-, Pune	5,000
30.	Baban Sabale, Pune	1,000
	Total-	43,88,347

Andreas from Panaha (Swizerland) at Vansthali Office

Do you wish to Support and Contribute to Vansthali

'We are sure that many would like to help.'

There are number of ways in which to support Vanasthali Rural Development Centre Activities spread over 9 Districts of Maharashtra.

- You can donate Variety of books for children like Story Books, Poetry Books, Children's Magazines, Dictionaries, Moivational articles and biographies, books about their surroundings, Natural wealth and such similar useful literature mainly in Marathi. We also welcome books in Hindi and English too.
- You can also donate Novels, Fictional, Non-Fictional Books, Autobiographies, Travel logs, articles about various individual and organisation based efforts for Nature conservation. Various grassroot experiments which positively relate to common man's life and similar inspiring adult literature for Vanasthali Teachers, parents and other local adult population, who lack such on facility in their villages.
- Vanasthali Magazine - Advertisements to support the publication are very welcome, Additionally articles related to rural socio-economic ethos, Short stories for children and adults, Poetry, about changes we look forward to for the good future of the society, biotechnological developments around us which may improve rural life.
- You can also help by Purchasing the Publication at Rs. 100/- Per Issue.
- You can donate Science-math's based games and toys, puzzles, books, charts and models for the age group VRDC caters to. Usable and in working condition Mobile phones, Desktops, Laptops are welcome too.

- If you are a person from Science and Technology background, you can volunteer by giving your time and ideas and any necessary materials and tools to carry out small experiments to impress basic scientific concepts on the young curious minds.
- Handicraft is an important and well enjoyed activity among the beneficiary group. It has many educational uses too. So, you can donate variety of craft papers, Drawing books, colouring material like water colours, Color pencils etc. If you love to participate you can volunteer to teach new craft items.
- There are various needs one can satisfy by donating items like children's clothes, woolens for winter, Sarees, Dresses for women. Other useful items are Bed Sheets and blankets, Mats and durries, Light carpets, curtains and similar.
- You can donate any amount of money on any personal or social occasions like important festivals, birthdays and anniversaries.
- Please draw the cheque in favour of -

'Vanasthali Rural Development Centre'

Donations to VRDC are exempt from income tax under section 80-G under IT Act 1960.

Donations from overseas are accepted too as VRDC has FCRA registration & eligible to receive in foreign exchange.

*** Thanks to one and all ***

VANSTHALI RURAL DEVELOPMENT CENTRE, PUNE 411 016

BALANCE-SHEET

AS ON 31st March 2024

Funds & Liabilities	Amount Rs.	Amount Rs.
Trust funds or Corpus-		
Balance as per last Balance Sheet	70,30,352.00	
Adjustment during the year (give details)	1,00,000.00	71,30,352.00
Other Earmarked Funds. (Created under the Provisions of the Trust Deed or Scheme or out of the Income)		1,26,78,861.00
(AS per Schedule F)		
Depreciation fund –		
Sinking fund./Reserved fund/other fund		
Loans (Secured or Unsecured)		
From Trustees & Others		
Liabilities.		
For Expenses - Professional Fees		-
For Adv- Shrirampur-Manas Project		
For rent and other deposits		-
For Sundry credit (Employees PT)		
Balance of TDS		-
Income and Expenditure Account.		
Balance as per last Balance Sheet	2,14,72,055.83	
Less : Appropriation, if any		
Add : Surplus		
Less : Deficit.	62,01,350.66	1,52,70,705.17
Total		3,50,79,918.17

The above balance sheet to the best of my/our belief contains a true a/c of the funds &

Property & Asstes	Amount Rs.	Amount Rs.
Immovable Properties – [at cost]		68,68,594.77
(AS per Schedule B)		
Depreciation)if any,during the year		
Investments.**(AS per Schedule - G]**		2,41,61,430.34
Note :MV of the above investment		
Furniture & Fixture.- **(AS per Schedule B)**		7,05,251.57
Balance as per last balance sheet		
Addition during year		
Depreciation up to date.		
Loans (Secured or Unsecured):		
Loans scholarships		
Loan & Advance **(AS per Schedule-H)**		16,32,997.39
To Joint Secretary /Secretary.		
To Trustees/Treasurer/Employees		
To Contractors/ Lawyers/Others		
Cash & Bank Balance.		
[a]In SB Account - **(AS per Schedule- I)**		17,11,644.10
[b]With the Trustee.		
Income & expenditure Account.		
Balance as per balance sheet.		
Less : Appropriation if any		
Add : Deficit As per I & E A/C		
Total		3,50,79,918.17

liabilities and of the property and/ assets of the Trust.

Dated : 19/09/2024

Place: Pune

UDIN :24104973BKGRJN8507

Vanasthali Rural Development Centre Pune-16

President

Secretary

Treasurer

For Torvi Pethe & Company
Chartered Accountants

CA Santosh M. Pethe
Partner
MRN : 104973

TORVI PETHE & COMPANY FRN 120456W Chartered Accountants

VANSTHALI RURAL DEVELOPMENT CENTRE, PUNE 411 016

INCOME & EXPENDITURE ACCOUNT FOR THE YEAR ENDING 31st March 2025

Expenditure	Amount Rs.	Amount Rs.
To Expenditure in respect of properties		
Rates, Taxes, Ceases	73,574.00	
Repairs to Building		73,574.00
Insurance.		
Salaries.		-
Other Expenses.		
To Establishment Expenses.		6,43,426.21
(AS per Schedule A]		
To Travelling & Conveyance to Trustees.		
To Legal Expenses.		
To Audit fees.		90,860.00
To Contribution and fees.		
To Amount Written off : Bad Debts		
To Miscellaneous Expenses.		
To Depreciation.**(AS per Sch B)**		4,39,202.00
To Amount transferred to Reserve		
To Expenses on object of trust.		
a)Religious. -		
b)Educational . **(AS per Sch C)**		1,67,37,086.00
c)Medical Relief		
d)Relief of poverty		
e)Other charitable Objects.		
To Surplus c/o to Balance Sheet		
Total		**1,79,84,148.21**

Income	Amount Rs.	Amount Rs.
By Rent (realised)		
By Interest [realised)		
On Bank Fixed Deposit	13,24,602.90	
On Bank Saving Account	50,654.00	
		13,75,256.90
By Dividend: UTI Units		
By Donation in cash or kind.-		
General & Specific Donation		81,58,113.65
(As per Schedule D]		
By Grants.		
By Income from other sources.		
(AS per Schedule E)		22,49,427.00
By Transfer From Fund Liability		
To deficit c/o to Balance Sheet		62,01,350.66
Total		**1,79,84,148.21**

As per our report of even date.

For Torvi Pethe & Company
Chartered Accountants

CA Santosh M. Pethe
Partner
MRN : 104973

TORVI PETHE & COMPANY FRN 120456W Chartered Accountants

Dated : 19/09/2024
Place: Pune
UDIN :24104973BKGRJN8507

Vansthali Rural Development Centre Pune-16

President

Secretary

Treasurer

(Founder President Late Smt. Nirmala B. Purandare)

BOARD OF TRUSTEES

President - Smt. Nirmal Pendharkar
Secretary - Smt. Bharati Bhide
Treasurer - Smt. Sushama Sathaye

Smt. Meenaxi Pawar
Smt. Manik Kotwal
Smt. Vrunda Gupte
Mr. Abhay Shah

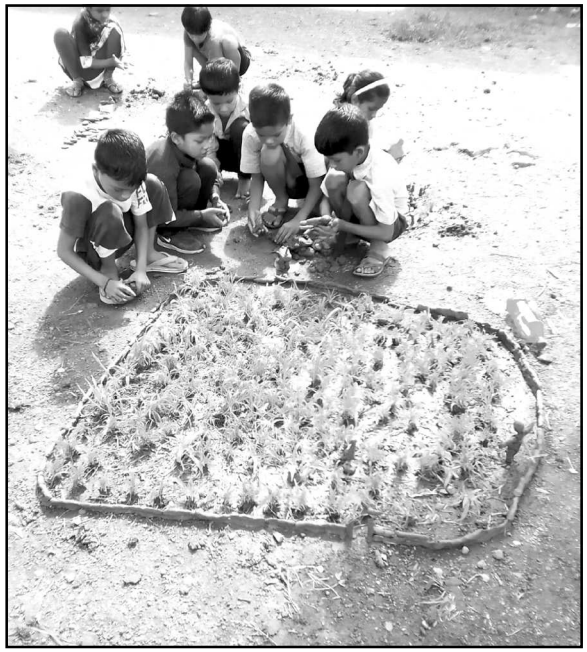
Auditors : Torvi Pethe & Co
Tax Consultants : G.N. Angal & Co

Public Charitable Trust No: F2076 (Pune)
Established: 21 December 1981

VANASTHALI RURAL DEVELOPMENT CENTRE

Kalindi Apts. 318/19 B, Canal Road,
Model Colony, Pune-411016.
Tel.No : (020) 25651550/25660124
E-mail : vanasthali515@gmail.com
Website : www.ngo-vanasthali.org

Science Project - Shivar Pheri



Hobby Class

Balwadi